

Psycholinguistics (ENG511)

- ✚ **Psycholinguistics:** The study of how humans acquire, process, and use language, examining the psychological and neurobiological factors that underlie language development, comprehension, and production
- ✚ **The Nature of Language: Psycholinguistics:** Language is a complex, dynamic system that involves cognitive processes, social interactions, and cultural influences, which psycholinguistics seeks to understand.
- ✚ **The Scope of Psycholinguistics:** Encompasses language development, language processing, language disorders, language teaching, and language acquisition, exploring the cognitive, social, and biological aspects of language.
- ✚ **Language Processes and Linguistic Knowledge:** Psycholinguistics examines how we process language (e.g., perception, comprehension, production) and how we acquire and represent linguistic knowledge (e.g., phonology, syntax, semantics).
- ✚ **The Historical Context:** Early psycholinguistics emerged in the 1950s, influenced by linguistics, psychology, and philosophy, with key figures like Noam Chomsky, Eric Lenneberg, and George Miller.
- ✚ **Early Psycholinguistics:** Focused on language acquisition, language universals, and the innateness of language, with Chomsky's generative grammar theory being a significant milestone.
- ✚ **The Information-Processing System:** A cognitive framework that views language processing as a series of stages, from input (perception) to output (production), involving working memory and long-term memory.
- ✚ **Working Memory and Long-term Memory:** Working memory temporarily holds and manipulates language information, while long-term memory stores linguistic knowledge and language representations.
- ✚ **Central Issues in Language Processing:** Include language ambiguity, language context, language development, language disorders, and language universals.

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- ✚ **Examples of Language Processing:** Language comprehension (e.g., understanding sentences), language production (e.g., speaking), and language acquisition (e.g., learning vocabulary).
- ✚ **Development of Processing System:** Language processing abilities develop in children through exposure to language, social interaction, and cognitive maturation.
- ✚ **Developing Working and Long Term Memory:** Children's working memory and long-term memory capacities expand as they develop language skills and cognitive abilities.
- ✚ **Language Comprehension:** The process of interpreting language meaning, involving semantic, syntactic, and pragmatic processing.
- ✚ **Perception of Language:** The initial stage of language processing, involving the recognition of speech sounds, words, and sentences.
- ✚ **The Structure of Speech:** Speech consists of phonemes (smallest units of sound), phonology (sound patterns), and prosody (rhythm and intonation).
- ✚ **Perception of Isolated Speech Segments:** Listeners recognize individual speech sounds and phonemes, which are the building blocks of language.
- ✚ **The Motor Theory of Speech Perception:** Proposes that speech perception is closely tied to speech production, suggesting that listeners use their own motor experiences to recognize spoken language.
- ✚ **Perception of Continuous Speech:** The process of recognizing spoken language in real-time, involving the ability to segment and identify individual sounds, words, and phrases.
- ✚ **Perception of Written Language:** The process of recognizing and interpreting written text, involving the ability to decode letters, words, and sentences.
- ✚ **Phonological Knowledge:** The mental representation of sound patterns in language, including phonemes, syllables, and prosody.
- ✚ **Phonological Knowledge:** Conceptual and Empirical Issues: Examines the nature of phonological knowledge, its acquisition, and the empirical methods used to study it.
- ✚ **Syntactic Knowledge:** The mental representation of grammatical rules and structures, including phrase structure, word order, and sentence formation.

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- ✚ **Children's Acquisition of Syntactic Knowledge:** The process by which children learn and develop syntactic knowledge, including the role of input, interaction, and cognitive development.
- ✚ **Morphological Knowledge:** The mental representation of the internal structure of words, including roots, prefixes, and suffixes.
- ✚ **Evaluating the Effectiveness of a Morphological Awareness Intervention:** Assessing the impact of instructional programs aimed at improving morphological knowledge and reading skills.
- ✚ **Semantic Knowledge:** The mental representation of word meanings, concepts, and relationships between them.
- ✚ **The Concept of a Semantic Network:** A theoretical framework representing semantic knowledge as a network of interconnected nodes and associations.
- ✚ **Hierarchical Network Models:** A type of semantic network model featuring a hierarchical organization of concepts and categories.
- ✚ **Spreading Activation Models:** A type of semantic network model where activation spreads from one node to neighboring nodes, influencing semantic processing.
- ✚ **Advantages and Disadvantages of Semantic Differential Scale:** A measurement tool used to assess semantic knowledge and connotative meanings, with both benefits (e.g., quantifiable data) and limitations (e.g., oversimplification).
- ✚ **Semantic Barriers:** Obstacles to effective communication arising from differences in semantic knowledge, conceptual frameworks, or linguistic expressions.
- ✚ **Difference Between Logogen and Cohort Model:** Two theoretical models of lexical access, with the logogen model positing a single, abstract representation of words and the cohort model proposing multiple, context-dependent representations.
- ✚ **Variables that Influence Lexicon Access:** Factors affecting the retrieval of words from memory, including frequency, context, and semantic priming.
- ✚ **Lexical Ambiguity:** Words or phrases with multiple meanings, requiring context to disambiguate.

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- ✚ **Appraising Models of Lexical Access:** Evaluating theories of how we retrieve words from memory, including logogen, cohort, and connectionist models.
- ✚ **Stages of Lexis in Speech Production:** The process of word selection, phonological encoding, and articulation in speech production.
- ✚ **Parsing:** The process of analyzing sentence structure and meaning, involving syntactic and semantic processing.
- ✚ **Parsing Strategies:** Top-down, bottom-up, and interactive approaches to parsing, influencing comprehension.
- ✚ **Modular Versus Interactive Models:** Debating whether language processing occurs in separate modules or through interactive networks.
- ✚ **Constraint-Based Model:** A parsing approach considering multiple constraints, like syntax and semantics, to resolve ambiguity.
- ✚ **Working Memory and Comprehension:** The role of working memory in language comprehension, including capacity and processing limitations.
- ✚ **Incomplete or Inaccurate Representations:** How incomplete or inaccurate mental representations affect language comprehension and production.
- ✚ **Comprehending Figurative Language:** Understanding non-literal language, like metaphors, idioms, and irony.
- ✚ **Types of Figurative Language:** Metaphors, similes, personification, hyperbole, and idioms, each with unique comprehension processes.
- ✚ **Studies of Figurative Language Comprehension:** Empirical research investigating how people process and interpret figurative language.
- ✚ **Comparison and Contrast: Pragmatic Theory and Conceptual Metaphor Theory:** Two theoretical approaches to understanding figurative language comprehension.
- ✚ **Class Inclusion Theory:** A theory positing that figurative language comprehension involves categorization and class inclusion processes.
- ✚ **Comparative Figurative Languages:** Cross-linguistic studies of figurative language, revealing differences and similarities in comprehension processes.
- ✚ **Memory for Meaning Versus Surface Form:** The distinction between remembering sentence meaning and surface-level details.

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- ✚ **Time Course of Retention and Pragmatic Factor:** How retention of language information changes over time, influenced by pragmatic factors like context and relevance.
- ✚ **Inferences and Sentence Memory:** How people draw inferences from sentences and remember them, including the role of prior knowledge and context.
- ✚ **False Recognition Errors:** The tendency to mistakenly recognize sentences or events, revealing the constructive nature of memory.
- ✚ **Propositions and Sentence Memory:** The mental representation of sentence meaning, including the role of propositions (basic units of meaning) in sentence memory.
- ✚ **Analysis of Propositions, Sentences, and Clause type:** Examining the structure and meaning of sentences, including clause types and propositional analysis.
- ✚ **Local and Global Discourse Structure:** The organization of discourse at both local (sentence-level) and global (text-level) levels, influencing comprehension.
- ✚ **Discourse Structure:** Theory, Practice, and Use: Understanding how discourse structure is created, used, and interpreted in communication.
- ✚ **Cohesion Strategies Used to Establish Coherence:** Linguistic devices (e.g., pronouns, conjunctions) that connect sentences and create coherent discourse.
- ✚ **Identifying New Topics of Discourse:** How listeners/readers recognize topic shifts and adjust their understanding accordingly.
- ✚ **Role of Working Memory:** The contribution of working memory to discourse comprehension, including the temporary storage and manipulation of information.
- ✚ **Memory for Discourse:** Surface Representations: The mental representation of discourse at a surface level, including exact wording and sentence structure.
- ✚ **Propositional Representations:** The mental representation of discourse meaning, including the extraction of propositions and relationships.
- ✚ **Inferences and Propositional Representations:** How inferences are drawn from propositional representations to enhance discourse understanding.
- ✚ **Situational Models:** Mental models of discourse context, including characters, events, and settings.

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- ✚ **Simultaneous Investigations of all Three Levels:** Examining surface, propositional, and situational levels simultaneously to understand discourse comprehension.
- ✚ **Schemata:** Pre-existing knowledge structures that influence discourse comprehension and interpretation.
- ✚ **Genres:** Categories of discourse (e.g., narratives, arguments) with characteristic structures and conventions.
- ✚ **Narrative Discourse Processing:** The cognitive processes involved in understanding and producing narratives, including story structure and character development.
- ✚ **inaccessibility of Knowledge:** The idea that some aspects of language and cognition are difficult or impossible to access consciously, influencing language production and comprehension.
- ✚ **Identifying the Main Points:** Extracting the most important information from language input, involving cognitive processes like attention and working memory.
- ✚ **Building Global Structures:** Constructing a mental representation of discourse, integrating local and global information to form a coherent whole.
- ✚ **Sign Language:** A True Language Without Speech: Sign language as a fully formed language with its own grammar, vocabulary, and syntax, challenging the idea that language requires speech.
- ✚ **Speech-Based Sign Languages:** Sign languages that emerge from spoken languages, like pidgin sign languages.
- ✚ **Basic Grammatical Concepts:** Fundamental ideas in grammar, such as phrase structure, word order, and agreement, which are universal across languages.
- ✚ **Insights from Sign Language:** Studying sign language to gain a deeper understanding of language structure, cognition, and development.
- ✚ **Transformational Grammar:** A theoretical framework proposing that language involves transformations of underlying structures to produce surface-level expressions.
- ✚ **Issues in Grammatical Theory:** Debates and challenges in developing a comprehensive theory of grammar, including the role of innateness, acquisition, and universals.

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- ✚ **Production of Speech:** The cognitive processes involved in generating spoken language, including planning, execution, and monitoring.
- ✚ **Language Slips of Tongue:** Errors in speech production, revealing the complex processes involved in language planning and execution.
- ✚ **Types of Error Speech:** Different types of speech errors, such as phonological, lexical, and syntactic errors.
- ✚ **Common Properties of Speech Error:** Characteristics shared by speech errors, like the tendency to preserve grammaticality and phonological similarity.
- ✚ **Explanations of Speech Errors:** Theoretical accounts of speech errors, including Freudian (psychodynamic) and psycholinguistic (cognitive) perspectives.
- ✚ **Differences in Freudian and Psycholinguistics Explanation:** Contrasting views on speech errors, with Freudian approaches emphasizing unconscious motivations and psycholinguistic approaches focusing on cognitive processes.
- ✚ **Serial Models of Linguistic Planning:** The idea that language planning occurs in a sequential, step-by-step manner.
- ✚ **Independence of Planning Units:** The proposal that language planning involves independent units, like words or phrases, rather than a holistic process.
- ✚ **Editing Processes:** Cognitive mechanisms that monitor and correct language production, influencing the final output.
- ✚ **Freud's View of Slips of Tongue:** Sigmund Freud's psychoanalytic perspective on speech errors, attributing them to unconscious thoughts, repressed desires, and conflicts.
- ✚ **Parallel Models of Linguistic Planning:** Theoretical frameworks proposing that language planning occurs in parallel, with multiple processes happening simultaneously.
- ✚ **The Role of Agreement:** The importance of agreement between speakers in conversation, including grammatical agreement and consensus-building.
- ✚ **Articulating Planning and Production Cycles:** The cognitive processes involved in language production, including planning, execution, and monitoring.

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- ✚ **Articulating Planning and Production:** The relationship between planning and production in language, with planning influencing production and vice versa.
- ✚ **Articulating Cycle:** A model of language production proposing a cyclical process of planning, execution, and monitoring.
- ✚ **Self-Monitoring Editing Expressions:** The ability to monitor and edit one's own language production, influencing the final output.
- ✚ **Insights from Sign Language:** Studying sign language to gain a deeper understanding of language structure, cognition, and development, including the role of gesture and visual processing.
- ✚ **The Structure of Conversation:** The organization and patterns of conversation, including opening, closing, taking turns, and negotiating topics.
- ✚ **Opening Conversations:** The strategies and conventions used to initiate conversations, including greetings and introductory phrases.
- ✚ **Closing Conversations:** The ways in which conversations are ended, including farewells, summaries, and final comments.
- ✚ **Taking Turns:** The rules and conventions governing turn-taking in conversation, including speaker selection and interruption.
- ✚ **Negotiating Topics of Conversations:** The processes by which speakers agree on and manage conversation topics.
- ✚ **Identifying Participants and Nonparticipants:** Recognizing who is involved in a conversation and who is not, influencing conversation dynamics.
- ✚ **CONVERSATIONAL PARTICIPANTS:** The roles and relationships of speakers in conversation, including friends, acquaintances, and gender differences.
- ✚ **Friends and Acquaintance:** The differences in conversation styles and strategies between friends and acquaintances.
- ✚ **Gender Differences in Conversation:** The variations in conversation patterns and strategies between men and women.
- ✚ **More Recent Work on Interpreting the Conversational Strategies:** Current research and findings on conversation, including the role of power dynamics, context, and culture.
- ✚ **Conversational Settings:** The social contexts in which conversations take place, influencing language use and communication.

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- ✚ **Therapeutic Discourse:** Language used in therapeutic settings, such as counseling or psychotherapy, with a focus on understanding and addressing mental health issues.
- ✚ **Other Forms of Institutional Discourse:** Language used in various institutional settings, like education, law, or medicine, with unique conventions and power dynamics.
- ✚ **Prelinguistic Communication:** Communication before language development, including gestures, facial expressions, and vocalizations.
- ✚ **Prelinguistic Gestures:** Gestures used by infants and young children to communicate before language emergence.
- ✚ **Early Phonology:** The development of speech sounds and sound patterns in young children.
- ✚ **Early Words on Lexical Development:** The acquisition of vocabulary in early childhood, including word meanings and usage.
- ✚ **Early Grammar:** The emergence of grammatical structures and rules in early childhood language development.
- ✚ **Emergence of Grammatical Categories:** The development of grammatical categories like noun, verb, and adjective in early childhood.
- ✚ **Later Grammar:** The continued development and refinement of grammatical structures and rules in later childhood and adulthood.
- ✚ **Cross-Linguistics Differences in Later Grammar:** Variations in grammatical structures and rules across different languages.
- ✚ **Metalinguistic and Discourse:** The ability to think about and reflect on language, as well as the role of discourse in shaping language use and communication.
- ✚ **Discourse Processes in Children:** How children develop and use language in social contexts, including conversation and narrative.
- ✚ **Language in School:** The role of language in educational settings, including reading, writing, and academic discourse.
- ✚ **Reading and Language Development:** The relationship between reading and language development, including the impact of reading on vocabulary and comprehension.
- ✚ **Contexts of Childhood & Bilingualism:** The social and cultural contexts of childhood, including the impact of bilingualism on language development.

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- ✚ **Bilingual First-Language Acquisitions:** The simultaneous acquisition of two languages in early childhood.
- ✚ **Second Language Acquisitions:** The acquisition of a second language later in life, including the role of age, motivation, and instruction.
- ✚ **Metalinguistic Awareness:** The ability to think about and reflect on language, including awareness of language structures, rules, and conventions.
- ✚ **Cognitive Control:** The executive function processes involved in language production, comprehension, and problem-solving, including attention, working memory, and inhibitory control.
- ✚ **Problem Solving and Creativity:** The cognitive processes involved in generating novel solutions, including the role of language in creative thinking.
- ✚ **Introduction to Process of Language Acquisition:** The initial stages of language development, including the acquisition of phonology, vocabulary, and grammar.
- ✚ **Feral and Isolated Children:** Children raised without human interaction or language exposure, providing insights into the role of environment and social interaction in language development.
- ✚ **The Critical Period Hypothesis:** The idea that language acquisition is optimal during a specific age range (0-7 years), with decreasing ability thereafter.
- ✚ **Critical Period Effects in Second Language Learning:** The impact of age on second language acquisition, with younger learners exhibiting greater proficiency and native-like speech.
- ✚ **Motherese:** The specialized language used by caregivers when speaking to infants and young children, characterized by simplified vocabulary, exaggerated intonation, and repetition.
- ✚ **Some Characteristics of Adult Speech to Children:** The distinct features of adult language when addressing children, including slower speech rate, higher pitch, and increased use of imperatives and questions.

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